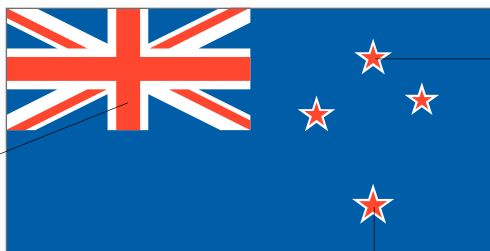


New Zealand

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** June 12, 1902 **Usage:** National

The Union Jack in the canton recalls New Zealand's colonial ties to Britain



Four white-bordered red stars represent the Southern Cross

The stars all vary slightly in size

Australasia and Oceania



New Zealand was settled by the British in the 1800s and was a colony from 1841. It became a dominion in 1907 and fully independent in 1947.

New Zealand's first flag was adopted before it became a British colony. Chosen by an assembly of Maori chiefs in 1834, the flag was of a St. George's Cross with another cross in the canton containing four stars on a blue field. After the formation of the colony in 1841, British ensigns began to be used.

A NEW NATIONAL FLAG

The current flag was designed and adopted for restricted use in 1869 and became the national flag in 1902. It is the British Blue Ensign, with a highly stylized representation of the Southern Cross constellation. It depicts only four of the five stars in the constellation.

Overseas Territories



COOK ISLANDS

The 15 stars on the fly represent the 15 main islands of the group; they are arranged in a ring to indicate that each island is of equal importance.



NIUE

The link with the UK is shown by the use of the Union Jack; that with New Zealand by the four stars. The large central star represents Niue itself.